

With over 50+ applications on display including their mobile applications and cloud based solutions, it can get really overwhelming to figure out which app is the right fit for you but with this guide, you will know exactly what this application ties into inside the ecosystem.

Below is a brief list of the most prominent buddy apps for After Effects (apps from which After Effects can import):

i) Adobe Photoshop

Mostly used by photographers and artists, this doesn't have much utility in conjunction with AE if single images are considered but it's super useful while throwing a bunch of pictures together. Creatives can go crazy with transitions and layouts while overlaying text and graphics beautifully over amazing works of art. Raster art commonly in .BMP, .GIF, .JPEG, .PNG, and .TIFF files can comfortably be used in AE.

ii) Adobe Illustrator

A Design software that's stored in the vector form (common extensions include .AI, .EPS, .PDF, and .SVG files) is also one of the prime candidates that gets along well with After Effects. A lot of design capabilities of Illustrator when combined with AE can make a world of a difference and produce some truly remarkable outputs. A lot of simple videos we see on social media are products of this, as are minor GIFs and motion pictures with simple text overlay.

iii) Adobe Premiere Pro

A lot of people either use this or AE when it comes to video editing and we will see more about this in the next section but for now the main observation to be made is that since both are pretty similar applications, files are easily movable between the two.

iv) Adobe Media Encoder

Different from all the other apps because AE exports to here whereas AE usually imports from the other applications.

v) Adobe Bridge

A universal file manager for all file types and Adobe applications. Some of the other apps that can be used directly and indirectly (via other related Adobe applications) with AE are Adobe Lightroom (minor edits like colour